

# Jordi Martínez-Muñoz

## | Curriculum Vitae

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Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Economics, University of California, San Diego

### EDUCATION

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**University of California, San Diego**

*Ph.D. in Economics*

**CA, USA**

*Expected 2027*

**Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)**

*M.S. in Economic Theory*

**Ciudad de México, México**

*July 2019*

**Universidad de Costa Rica (UCR)**

*B.S. in Economics*

**Costa Rica**

*October 2015*

### FIELDS

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Experimental and Behavioral Economics; Microeconomic Theory

### REFERENCES

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**Emanuel Vespa (Chair)**

evespa@ucsd.edu

**Isabel Trevino**

itrevino@ucsd.edu

**Joel Sobel**

jsobel@ucsd.edu

### JOB MARKET PAPER

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*"Beyond the Exploration-Exploitation Trade-off: The Behavioral Structure of Switching"*

Many sequential decision problems—research and development, investment projects, and contractual relationships—involve choosing between alternatives whose quality can only be learned through experience. Choosing an alternative of uncertain quality provides information about its underlying quality, but at the cost of less predictable payoffs relative to more familiar alternatives. A common normative benchmark for how agents switch between alternatives is that switching decisions respond to new information about their relative qualities.

I take a step back and ask whether new information about alternative quality is necessary for a switching decision. Using an incentivized one-armed bandit experiment—a repeated choice between a known-quality option and a quality-uncertain one—I find that it is not. More than half of subjects deviate from the benchmark by switching even when outcomes provide no new information about the relative quality of the alternatives. These subjects choose the uncertain alternative more often and earn 25% less than subjects who follow the normative benchmark. Consistent with this, when these subjects are constrained to use the normative switching strategy, they choose the uncertain alternative less often.

I use additional experimental variation to distinguish between types of deviations from the benchmark. One type attenuates or disappears when subjects are encouraged to evaluate decisions over multiple rounds rather than react to individual outcomes, consistent with experience-driven deviations, arising from the experience of play. A second persists even when subjects neither execute the choice strategy themselves nor observe round-by-round outcomes, suggesting valuation-driven deviations, reflecting differences in how subjects evaluate the alternatives themselves.

## OTHER WORKING PAPERS

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- *Legal Information as an Input to Health Risk Assessments: Evidence from E-Cigarettes in Latin America* (with José Antonio Márquez, Fernando Briseño, and Víctor Pérez). When the health risks of an activity are uncertain, individuals may use its legal status as a signal when assessing those risks. We use a randomized survey experiment in Mexico, Argentina, and Chile to test whether information about e-cigarette regulation causes individuals to update their perceptions of health risk.
- *Work in Progress. The Role of Risk in Strategic Exploration*. I experimentally study how the payoff distribution of the familiar arm affects behavior in a one-armed strategic-experimentation problem. In particular, I examine the empirical validity of the model's prediction of under-exploration across different payoff distributions of the familiar arm.
- *Work in Progress. Forecast Distortions, Choice Distortions: Testing the Reach of the Gambler's and Hot-Hand Fallacies*. The gambler's and hot-hand fallacies document that people's beliefs about a known random process deviate from its stated probability after a short observed streak. I test whether this belief distortion carries through to a real, incentivized choice between two known-probability options, or whether choice remains anchored to the correct probability regardless of the streak just observed.

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

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**Referee:** *Games and Economic Behavior*

## RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### University of California, San Diego

*Research Assistant, Economics Lab (Prof. Emanuel Vespa)*

*Jan–Jun 2024*

- Managed and conducted laboratory sessions at the UCSD Economics Lab.

### Centro de Estudios Educativos y Sociales (CEES), México

*Junior Researcher*

*2019–2020*

- Collaboration on projects analyzing social programs in Honduras and the efficiency of social spending in the Northern Triangle countries of Central America (Guatemala, Honduras, and El Salvador).
- Translated the code for the 2018 Mexican Multidimensional Poverty Index from Stata to SPSS (July 2019).

### Universidad de Costa Rica

*Research Assistant*

*Jan 2016*

- Conducted and supervised interviews for the project "Commonalities and Differences in the Meaning of Happiness: People's Voices About Ideal Happiness," funded by the Toyota Foundation. Collected data across 25 towns in Costa Rica over 3 weeks. Professor: Yoshiaki Takahashi, University of Tsukuba.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### Main Instructor

*University of California, San Diego*

Intermediate Microeconomics, ECON 100B

*Summer 2024*

Decisions Under Uncertainty, ECON 171

*Summer 2025*

*Universidad de Costa Rica*

*2016–2017*

- Introduction to Economics for Non-Economists, XE-156
- Economic Data laboratory course. Introduce students to Stata programming (Teaching assistant).

## Teaching Assistant

University of California, San Diego

2021–Present

- School of Global Policy and Strategy: Microeconomics for Policy/Management (Master's level course), Fall 2021–2025
- Economics Department: ECON 100A, 100B, 120B, 120C, 142, 144
- Rady School of Management: MGT 160 (Experiments in Firms), MGR 444 (MBA, Topics in Business Strategy)

## TEACHING TRAINING

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- Summer Graduate Teaching Scholar Program, UC San Diego Engaged Teaching and Learning Commons, Summer 2024
- Engaged Teaching Scholar in Student-Centered College Teaching, UC San Diego Engaged Teaching and Learning Commons, Summer 2024
- Leadership in Teaching: Graduate Peer Review of Instruction Program, UC San Diego Engaged Teaching and Learning Commons, Summer 2024

## PRESENTATIONS

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- Theory, Behavioral and Experimental Workshop, UC San Diego, Department of Economics

## AWARDS

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- UC San Diego Yankelovich Graduate Research Funding Scholarship, 2025
- UC San Diego Economics Department Travel and Research Grant, Spring 2023 and Fall 2024
- Honorable mention for Master's Thesis: *Three Models of Menu Preferences with Costly Choice*, July 2019
- First place (out of 25 groups) in Lecturer Evaluation Survey, Introduction to Economics, UCR, Spring 2017

## OTHER INFORMATION

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**Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (basic)

**Programming:** Microsoft Office, Stata, R, EViews, Tableau, LaTeX, MATLAB, Python, oTree, HTML, SPSS (basic)